

¹⁶From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. ¹⁷For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. ¹⁸No one has ever seen God, but the one and only Son, who is Himself God and^a is at the Father's side,^b has made Him known.

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1–5; Matthew 3:1–12; Mark 1:1–8; Luke 3:1–20

¹⁹And this was John's testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him, "Who are you?" ²⁰He did not refuse to confess, but openly declared, "I am not the Christ."

²¹"Then who are you?" they inquired. "Are you Elijah?"

He said, "I am not."

"Are you the Prophet?"

He answered, "No."

²²So they said to him, "Who are you? We need an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?"

²³John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet:

"I am a voice of one calling in the wilderness,

'Make straight the way for the Lord.'"^c

²⁴Then the Pharisees who had been sent ²⁵asked him, "Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?"

²⁶"I baptize with^d water," John replied, "but among you stands One you do not know. ²⁷He is the One who comes after me, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie."

²⁸All this happened at Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

Jesus the Lamb of God

Matthew 3:13–17; Mark 1:9–11; Luke 3:21–22

²⁹The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! ³⁰This is He of whom I said, 'A man who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.' ³¹I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that He might be revealed to Israel."

³²Then John testified, "I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove and resting on Him. ³³I myself did not know

^a Or *but the only begotten God, who* ; BYZ and TR *but the only begotten Son, who* ^b Greek *in the Father's bosom* ^c Isaiah 40:3 (see also LXX) ^d Or *in* ; also in verse 31 and twice in 33

Him, but the One who sent me to baptize with water told me, 'The man on whom you see the Spirit descend and rest is He who will baptize with the Holy Spirit.' ³⁴I have seen and testified that this is the Son of God."^a

The First Disciples

Matthew 4:18–22; Mark 1:16–20; Luke 5:1–11

³⁵The next day John was there again with two of his disciples. ³⁶When he saw Jesus walking by, he said, "Look, the Lamb of God!" ³⁷And when the two disciples heard him say this, they followed Jesus.

³⁸Jesus turned and saw them following. "What do you want?" He asked.

They said to Him, "Rabbi" (which means Teacher), "where are You staying?"

³⁹"Come and see," He replied. So they went and saw where He was staying, and spent that day with Him. It was about the tenth hour.^b

⁴⁰Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, was one of the two who heard John's testimony and followed Jesus. ⁴¹He first found his brother Simon and told him, "We have found the Messiah" (which is translated as Christ).

⁴²Andrew brought him to Jesus, who looked at him and said, "You are Simon son of John. You will be called Cephas" (which is translated as Peter).

Jesus Calls Philip and Nathanael

⁴³The next day Jesus decided to set out for Galilee. Finding Philip, He told him, "Follow Me." ⁴⁴Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the same town as Andrew and Peter.

⁴⁵Philip found Nathanael and told him, "We have found the One Moses wrote about in the Law, the One the prophets foretold — Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph."

⁴⁶"Can anything good come from Nazareth?" Nathanael asked.

"Come and see," said Philip.

⁴⁷When Jesus saw Nathanael approaching, He said of him, "Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is no deceit."

⁴⁸"How do You know me?" Nathanael asked.

Jesus replied, "Before Philip called you, I saw you under the fig tree."

⁴⁹"Rabbi," Nathanael answered, "You are the Son of God! You are the King of Israel!"

^a SBL *the Chosen One of God* ^b That is, about four in the afternoon

¹⁰ “You are Israel’s teacher,” said Jesus, “and you do not understand these things?” ¹¹ Truly, truly, I tell you, we speak of what we know, and we testify to what we have seen, and yet you people do not accept our testimony.

¹² If I have told you about earthly things and you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you about heavenly things? ¹³ No one has ascended into heaven except the One who descended from heaven—the Son of Man.^a ¹⁴ Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, ¹⁵ that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.^b

¹⁶ For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only^c Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him. ¹⁸ Whoever believes in Him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe has already been condemned, because he has not believed in the name of God’s one and only Son.

¹⁹ And this is the verdict: The Light has come into the world, but men loved the darkness rather than the Light because their deeds were evil. ²⁰ Everyone who does evil hates the Light, and does not come into the Light for fear that his deeds will be exposed. ²¹ But whoever practices the truth comes into the Light, so that it may be seen clearly that what he has done has been accomplished in God.”^d

John’s Testimony about Jesus

²² After this, Jesus and His disciples went into the Judean countryside, where He spent some time with them and baptized.

²³ Now John was also baptizing at Aenon near Salim, because the water was plentiful there, and people kept coming to be baptized. ²⁴ (For John had not yet been thrown into prison.)

²⁵ Then a dispute arose between John’s disciples and a certain Jew^e over the issue of ceremonial washing. ²⁶ So John’s disciples came to him and said, “Look, Rabbi, the One who was with you beyond the Jordan, the One you testified about — He is baptizing, and everyone is going to Him.”

²⁷ John replied, “A man can receive only what is given him from heaven. ²⁸ You yourselves can testify that I said, ‘I am not the Christ, but am sent ahead of Him.’ ²⁹ The bride belongs to the bridegroom. The friend of the bridegroom stands and listens for him,

^a BYZ and TR include *who is in heaven*. ^b Or *everyone who believes may have eternal life in Him*. ^c Or *only begotten or unique*; also in verse 18 ^d Some translators close this quotation after verse 15. ^e TR *and the Jews*

and is overjoyed to hear the bridegroom’s voice. That joy is mine, and it is now complete. ³⁰ He must increase; I must decrease.

³¹ The One who comes from above is above all. The one who is from the earth belongs to the earth and speaks as one from the earth. The One who comes from heaven is above all.^a ³² He testifies to what He has seen and heard, yet no one accepts His testimony. ³³ Whoever accepts His testimony has certified that God is truthful. ³⁴ For the One whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for God gives the Spirit without limit.

³⁵ The Father loves the Son and has placed all things in His hands. ³⁶ Whoever believes in the Son has eternal life. Whoever rejects the Son will not see life. Instead, the wrath of God remains on him.”^b

Jesus and the Samaritan Woman

4 ¹ When Jesus realized that the Pharisees were aware He^c was gaining and baptizing more disciples than John

² (although it was not Jesus who baptized, but His disciples), ³ He left Judea and returned to Galilee.

⁴ Now He had to pass through Samaria. ⁵ So He came to a town of Samaria called Sychar, near the plot of ground that Jacob had given to his son Joseph. ⁶ Since Jacob’s well was there, Jesus, weary from His journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour.^d

⁷ When a Samaritan woman came to draw water, Jesus said to her, “Give Me a drink.” ⁸ (His disciples had gone into the town to buy food.)

⁹ “You are a Jew,” said the woman. “How can You ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?” (For Jews do not associate with Samaritans.)^e

¹⁰ Jesus answered, “If you knew the gift of God and who is asking you for a drink, you would have asked Him, and He would have given you living water.”

¹¹ “Sir,” the woman replied, “You have nothing to draw with and the well is deep. Where then will You get this living water? ¹² Are You greater than our father Jacob, who gave us this well and drank from it himself, as did his sons and his livestock?”

¹³ Jesus said to her, “Everyone who drinks this water will be thirsty again. ¹⁴ But whoever drinks the water I give him will never

^a Tischendorf *The One comes from heaven*. ^b Some translators close this quotation after verse 30. ^c Literally *When therefore Jesus knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus*; NE, WH, BYZ, and TR *When therefore the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus* ^d That is, about noon ^e Tischendorf does not include this sentence.

Division over Jesus

⁴⁰On hearing these words, some of the people said, “This is truly the Prophet.”

⁴¹Others declared, “This is the Christ.”

But still others asked, “How can the Christ come from Galilee? ⁴²Doesn’t the Scripture say that the Christ will come from the line of David and from Bethlehem, the village where David lived?^a”

⁴³So there was division in the crowd because of Jesus. ⁴⁴Some of them wanted to seize Him, but no one laid a hand on Him.

The Unbelief of the Jewish Leaders

⁴⁵Then the officers returned to the chief priests and Pharisees, who asked them, “Why didn’t you bring Him in?”

⁴⁶“Never has anyone spoken like this man!” the officers answered.

⁴⁷“Have you also been deceived?” replied the Pharisees.

⁴⁸“Have any of the rulers or Pharisees believed in Him? ⁴⁹But this crowd that does not know the law— they are under a curse.”

⁵⁰Nicodemus, who had gone to Jesus earlier and who himself was one of them, asked, ⁵¹“Does our law convict a man without first hearing from him to determine what he has done?”

⁵²“Aren’t you also from Galilee?” they replied. “Look into it, and you will see that no prophet comes out of Galilee.”^b

⁵³Then each went to his own home.

The Woman Caught in Adultery



¹ But Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.

²Early in the morning He went back into the temple courts.^c All the people came to Him, and He sat down to teach them. ³The scribes and Pharisees, however, brought to Him a woman caught in adultery. They made her stand before them ⁴and said, “Teacher, this woman was caught in the act of adultery. ⁵In the Law Moses commanded us to stone such a woman. So what do You say?”

⁶They said this to test Him, in order to have a basis for accusing Him. But Jesus bent down and began to write on the ground with His finger.

⁷When they continued to question Him, He straightened up and said to them, “Let him who is without sin among you be the

first to cast a stone at her.” ⁸And again He bent down and wrote on the ground.

⁹When they heard this,^a they began to go away one by one, beginning with the older ones, until only Jesus was left, with the woman standing there. ¹⁰Then Jesus straightened up^b and asked her, “Woman, where are your accusers?^c Has no one condemned you?”

¹¹“No one, Lord,” she answered.

“Then neither do I condemn you,” Jesus declared. “Now go and sin no more.”

Jesus the Light of the World

1 John 1:5–10

¹²Once again, Jesus spoke to the people and said, “I am the light of the world. Whoever follows Me will never walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life.”

¹³So the Pharisees said to Him, “You are testifying about Yourself; Your testimony is not valid.”

¹⁴Jesus replied, “Even if I testify about Myself, My testimony is valid, because I know where I came from and where I am going. But you do not know where I came from or where I am going. ¹⁵You judge according to the flesh; I judge no one. ¹⁶But even if I do judge, My judgment is true, because I am not alone; I am with the Father who sent Me.^d ¹⁷Even in your own Law it is written that the testimony of two men is valid.^e ¹⁸I am One who testifies about Myself, and the Father, who sent Me, also testifies about Me.”

¹⁹“Where is Your Father?” they asked Him.

“You do not know Me or My Father,” Jesus answered. “If you knew Me, you would know My Father as well.”

²⁰He spoke these words while teaching in the temple courts, near the treasury. Yet no one seized Him, because His hour had not yet come.

²¹Again He said to them, “I am going away, and you will look for Me, but you will die in your sin. Where I am going, you cannot come.”

²²So the Jews began to ask, “Will He kill Himself, since He says, ‘Where I am going, you cannot come?’”

²³Then He told them, “You are from below; I am from above. You are of this world; I am not of this world. ²⁴That is why I told

^a NE, BYZ, and TR include *and were convicted by their conscience*, ^b NE, BYZ, and TR include *and saw no one but the woman*. ^c WH and NA *where are they* ^d Literally *but (it is) I and the Father who sent Me*; NE *but (it is) I and the One who sent Me* ^e See Deuteronomy 19:15.

^a See Micah 5:2. ^b Some early manuscripts do not include John 7:53 through John 8:11. ^c Literally *the temple*; also in verse 20

Jesus the Good Shepherd

Psalms 23:1-6; Ezekiel 34:11-24



¹ “Truly, truly, I tell you, whoever does not enter the sheepfold by the gate, but climbs in some other way, is a thief and a robber.

² But the one who enters by the gate is the shepherd of the sheep. ³ The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen for his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out.

⁴ When he has brought out all his own, he goes on ahead of them, and his sheep follow him because they know his voice. ⁵ But they will never follow a stranger; in fact, they will flee from him because they do not recognize his voice.”

⁶ Jesus spoke to them using this illustration, but they did not understand what He was telling them. ⁷ So He said to them again, “Truly, truly, I tell you, I am the gate for the sheep. ⁸ All who came before Me^a were thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not listen to them. ⁹ I am the gate. If anyone enters through Me, he will be saved. He will come in and go out and find pasture. ¹⁰ The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I have come that they may have life, and have it in all its fullness.

¹¹ I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down His life for the sheep. ¹² The hired hand is not the shepherd, and the sheep are not his own. When he sees the wolf coming, he abandons the sheep and runs away. Then the wolf pounces on them and scatters the flock. ¹³ The man runs away because he is a hired servant and is unconcerned for the sheep.

¹⁴ I am the good shepherd. I know My sheep and My sheep know Me, ¹⁵ just as the Father knows Me and I know the Father. And I lay down My life for the sheep. ¹⁶ I have other sheep that are not of this fold. I must bring them in as well, and they will listen to My voice. Then there will be one flock and one shepherd.

¹⁷ The reason the Father loves Me is that I lay down My life in order to take it up again. ¹⁸ No one takes it from Me, but I lay it down of My own accord. I have authority to lay it down and authority to take it up again. This charge I have received from My Father.”

¹⁹ Again there was division among the Jews because of Jesus’ message. ²⁰ Many of them said, “He is demon-possessed and insane. Why would you listen to Him?”

²¹ But others replied, “These are not the words of a man possessed by a demon. Can a demon open the eyes of the blind?”

Jesus at the Feast of Dedication

²² At that time the Feast of Dedication^a took place in Jerusalem. It was winter, ²³ and Jesus was walking in the temple courts^b in Solomon’s Colonnade. ²⁴ So the Jews gathered around Him and demanded, “How long will You keep us in suspense? If You are the Christ, tell us plainly.”

²⁵ “I already told you,” Jesus replied, “but you did not believe. The works I do in My Father’s name testify on My behalf. ²⁶ But because you are not My sheep, you refuse to believe. ²⁷ My sheep listen to My voice; I know them, and they follow Me. ²⁸ I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand. ²⁹ My Father who has given them to Me is greater than all. No one can snatch them out of My Father’s hand. ³⁰ I and the Father are one.”

³¹ At this, the Jews again picked up stones to stone Him. ³² But Jesus responded, “I have shown you many good works from the Father. For which of these do you stone Me?”

³³ “We are not stoning You for any good work,” said the Jews, “but for blasphemy, because You, who are a man, make Yourself out to be God.”

³⁴ Jesus replied, “Is it not written in your Law: ‘I have said you are gods’^c? ³⁵ If he called them gods to whom the word of God came — and the Scripture cannot be broken — ³⁶ then what about the One whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world? How then can you accuse Me of blasphemy for stating that I am the Son of God?”

³⁷ If I am not doing the works of My Father, then do not believe Me. ³⁸ But if I am doing them, even though you do not believe Me, believe the works themselves, so that you may know and understand that the Father is in Me, and I am in the Father.”

³⁹ At this, they tried again to seize Him, but He escaped their grasp.

John’s Testimony Confirmed

⁴⁰ Then Jesus went back across the Jordan to the place where John had first been baptizing, and He stayed there. ⁴¹ Many came to Him and said, “Although John never performed a sign, everything he said about this man was true.” ⁴² And many in that place believed in Jesus.

^a That is, Hanukkah, the historic celebration of the Maccabean Revolt and rededication of the temple ^b Literally *the temple* ^c Psalm 82:6

^a BYZ *All who came*